Synonyms & Antonyms (Set B)

Year 5 Accelerated · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Example: Choose the best synonym for 'tired' in: 'By the end of the hike, the children were utterly ___.' (sleepy / exhausted)

Answer: exhausted — it matches the intensity of 'utterly tired' far better than the milder word 'sleepy'.

Core Practice (15 questions)

1. Give a synonym for 'happy'.
2. Give an antonym for 'happy'.
3. Give a synonym for 'small'.
4. Give an antonym for 'small'.
5. Which word is a synonym for 'clever'? A) foolish B) intelligent C) silly D) slow E) dull
6. Which word is an antonym for 'clever'? A) bright B) smart C) foolish D) wise E) sharp
7. Give a synonym for 'finish'.
8. Give an antonym for 'finish'.
9. Give a synonym for 'calm'.
10. Select ALL the words below that are synonyms for 'tired'. A) exhausted B) lively C) weary D) energetic E) drained
11. Give an antonym for 'calm'.
12. Which word is a synonym for 'ancient'? A) modern B) new C) old D) young E) recent
13. Give a synonym for 'kind'.
14. Give an antonym for 'kind'.
15. Which word is an antonym for 'noisy'? A) loud B) quiet C) deafening D) booming E) blaring

Applied Practice (15 questions)

1. Give a synonym for 'looked' that suggests a quick, nervous look over one's shoulder.
2. Choose the best antonym for 'cheerful' in: "Her usually cheerful face looked ___ after hearing the bad news." A) bright B) gloomy C) radiant D) joyful E) merry
3. Give a synonym for 'whisper' (a quiet way of speaking).
4. Give a synonym for 'bellow' (a loud way of speaking).
5. Explain the shade-of-meaning difference between 'whisper' and 'mutter'.
6. Choose the best synonym for 'old' in: "The museum displayed a collection of ___ artefacts from centuries ago." A) new B) ancient C) modern D) recent E) fresh
7. Give an antonym for 'brave' that fits: "Unlike his brave older brother, Sam felt ___ about the roller coaster."
8. Which word is closest in meaning to 'stubborn'? A) flexible B) obliging C) headstrong D) agreeable E) cooperative

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9. Give a word that is the opposite of 'stubborn' (meaning easy to persuade).

10. Select ALL the words below could replace 'delighted' in "She was delighted with her exam results." A) thrilled B) disappointed C) overjoyed D) upset E) ecstatic

11. Give a synonym for 'enormous' that fits: "A ___ wave towered over the tiny boat."

12. Give a synonym for 'peculiar' that fits: "There was something ___ about the old house."

13. Give a synonym for 'exhausted' that is slightly milder (meaning quite tired but not totally drained).

14. Choose the best synonym for 'said' in: "'I don't think so,' she ___ firmly." A) shouted B) whispered C) stated D) giggled E) sighed

15. Give an antonym for 'generous' that fits: "The ___ landlord refused to fix anything."

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Give a word that is both a synonym for 'stingy' and an antonym for 'generous'.

2. Give a word that is both a synonym for 'eager' and an antonym for 'reluctant'.

3. Give a word that is both a synonym for 'ancient' and an antonym for 'modern'.

4. Give a word that is both a synonym for 'gigantic' and an antonym for 'minuscule'.

5. Give a word that is both a synonym for 'candid' and an antonym for 'evasive'.

6. A character is described across a story as 'content', then later 'ecstatic', then finally 'euphoric'. Put these three words in order from least to most intense happiness.

7. Which word correctly completes BOTH blanks with the same word: "The critic's review was so ___ that the author felt both flattered and a little suspicious of such ___ praise." A) scathing B) effusive C) muted D) measured E) terse

8. Select ALL the words below that could serve as antonyms for 'meticulous'. A) careless B) thorough C) sloppy D) painstaking E) careful

9. Explain why 'frugal' and 'miserly' are not perfect synonyms, even though both describe someone careful with money.

10. Give three synonyms for 'say', ranked from quietest to loudest.

11. Which pair of words are antonyms of EACH OTHER rather than synonyms? A) joyful / delighted B) furious / livid C) generous / stingy D) ancient / antique E) honest / candid

12. Give a word that means the opposite of 'optimistic' when describing someone's outlook on the future.

13. A thesaurus lists 'glance', 'peek', 'peep', 'glimpse' as near-synonyms for a quick look, and 'gape', 'gawp', 'ogle' for a longer, ruder stare. Explain in one sentence the key difference in connotation between the two groups.

14. Select ALL the words below that are synonyms for 'reluctant'. A) hesitant B) eager C) unwilling D) willing E) loath

15. Which word best replaces BOTH blanks: "Although she seemed ___ about the plan at first, by the end of the meeting she was completely ___ to go ahead." A) willing / reluctant B) reluctant / willing C) eager / willing D) hesitant / unwilling E) keen / eager

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